

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

Employment patterns, salary benchmarks, and workplace preferences for engineering managers and HR leaders

65,437

survey respondents

global sample

180+

countries

developer community

22,677

salary responses

34.7% response rate

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

84%

currently working

full-time, part-time, or
freelance

69%

global full-time

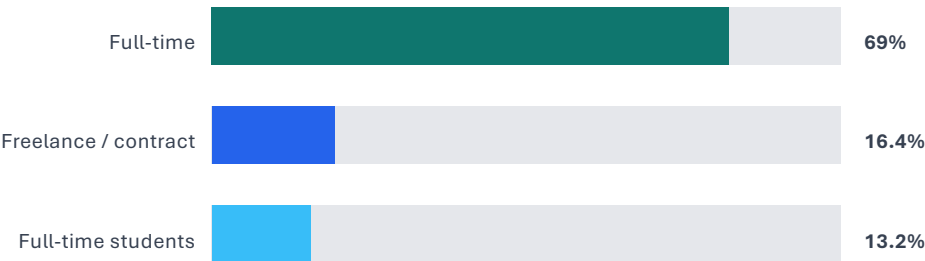
dominant employment mode

64.8%

U.S. full-time

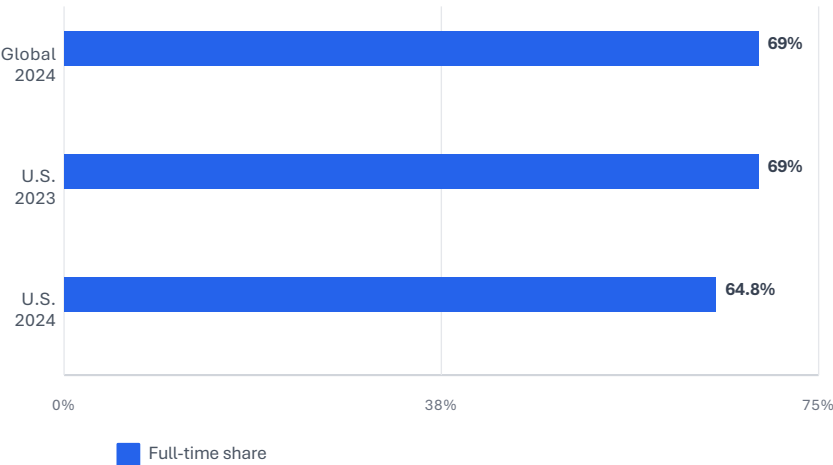
down from 69% in 2023

Reported global employment categories



Note: the brief reports these categories plus an overall “currently working” figure; it does not provide every employment-status category.

Full-time benchmark: global vs. U.S.

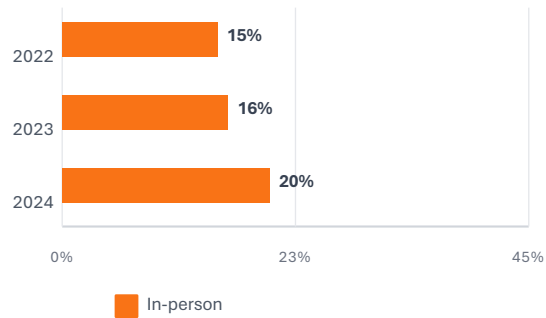


U.S. full-time employment fell 4 percentage points year-over-year, while freelancing / contracting remains significant globally at 16.4%.

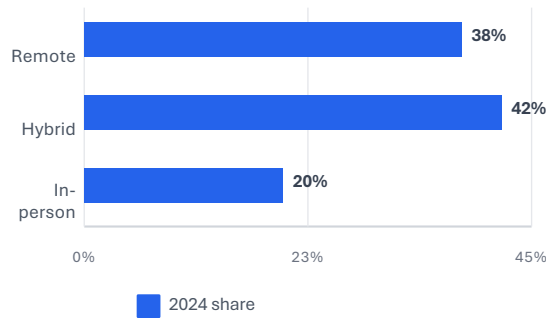
In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

Known work-environment data points from the brief

In-person trend



2024 work mode mix



The source provides a complete 2024 mix, plus the three-year in-person trend. Historical remote and hybrid shares beyond the stated 2023 hybrid value are not shown.

42%

hybrid in 2024

consistent with 2023

38%

remote in 2024

second-largest mode

20%

in-person in 2024

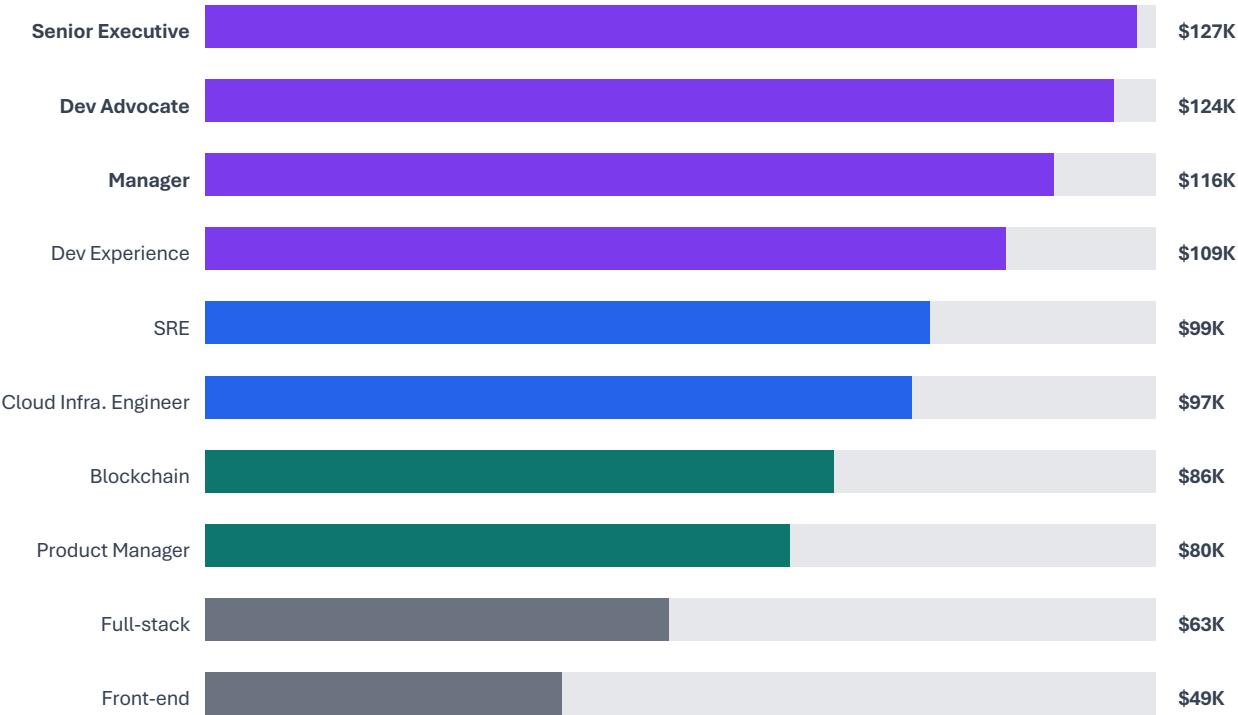
up from 15% in 2022

Interpretation

Return-to-office momentum is visible, but hybrid remains the center of gravity for retention planning.

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

Median annual compensation, USD — top 10 listed roles



Data source: figure_1.jpg and salary table in source brief (22,677 salary responses).

\$127K

Senior Executive median

~17 years average experience

\$124K

Dev Advocate median

~16 years average experience

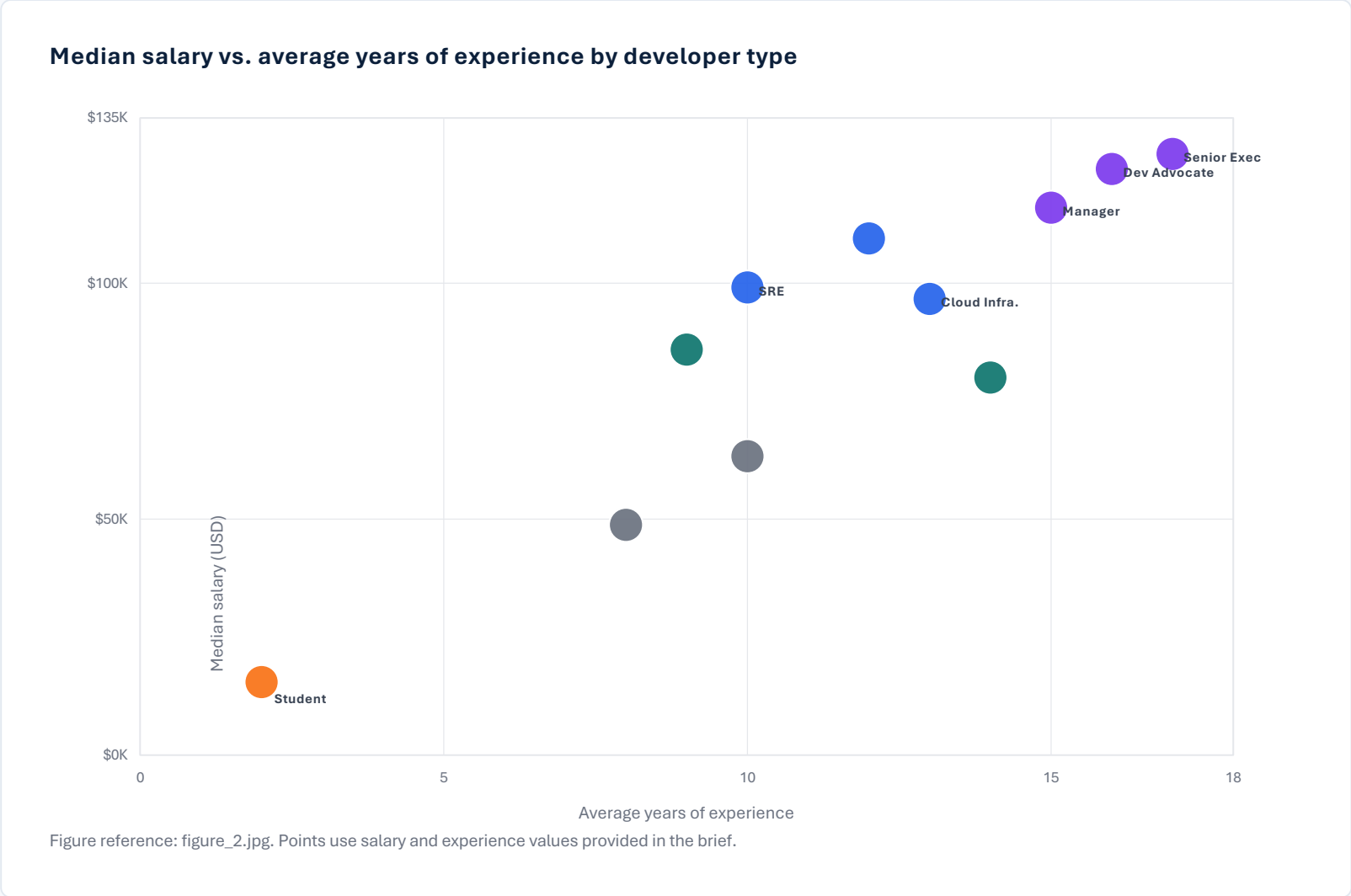
\$99K

SRE median

highest-paid listed pure technical role

Premiums concentrate in leadership, DevRel, and reliability / infrastructure roles.

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries



14+ yrs

upper-right cluster

Senior exec, Dev Advocate, Manager, Product Manager

\$15K

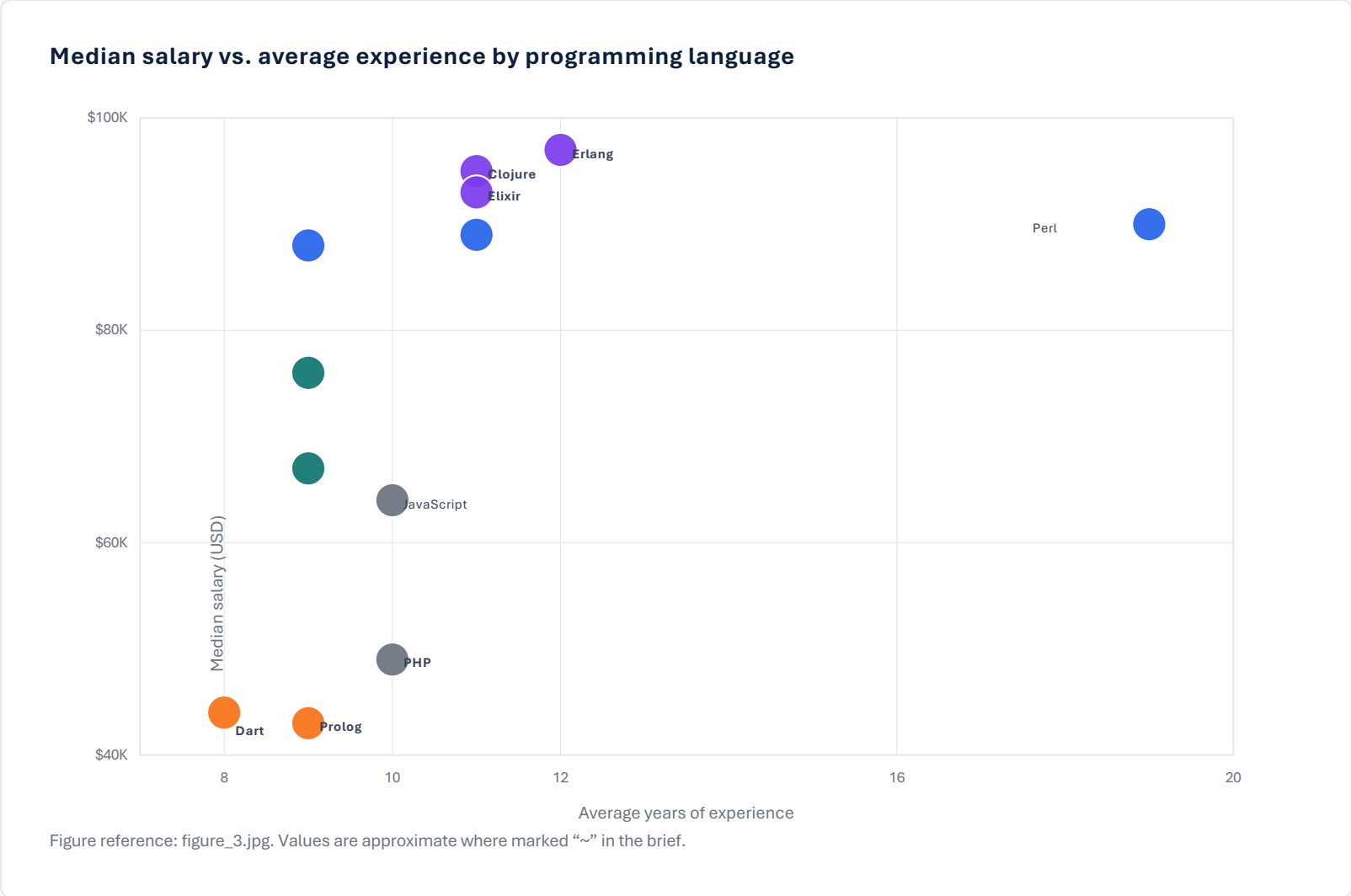
Student median salary

~2 years experience; lower-left outlier

Benchmarking implication

Pay bands should account for role criticality as well as tenure: SRE and cloud infrastructure roles out-earn several broader application roles.

Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K



\$97K
Erlang median
~12 years experience

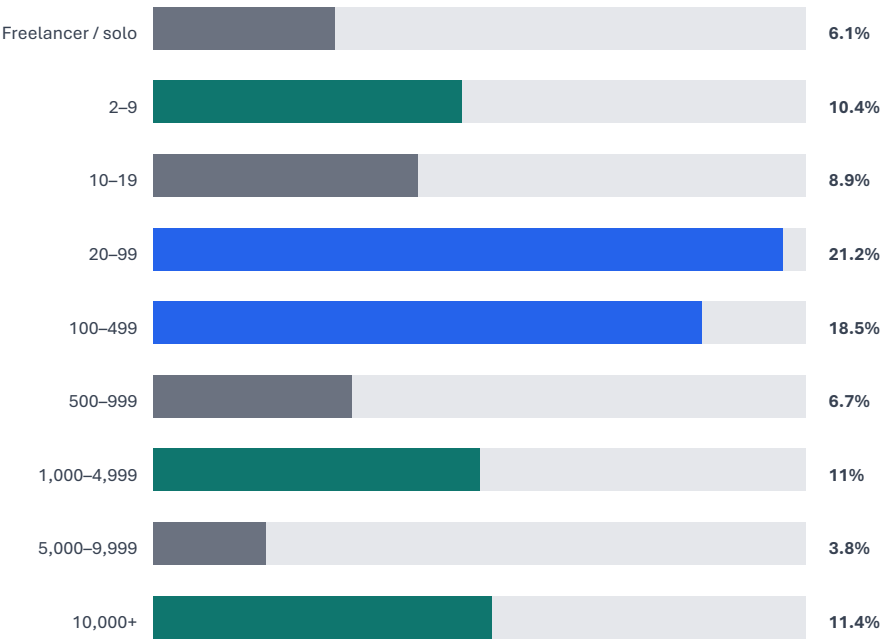
\$95K
Clojure median
~11 years experience

\$60–75K
2024 average salary range
roughly \$10K below 2023

Niche functional languages correlate with higher median pay; mainstream languages sit lower in the salary distribution.

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Company-size distribution, 42,827 respondents



Sub-100 organizations total 47%: freelancer / solo, 2-9, 10-19, and 20-99 employee groups.

Technology purchasing influence



Influence by role



Vendor-side implication: developers are not just users; they are evaluators and budget influencers.

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

01

Plan for a more flexible workforce

Full-time employment softened in the U.S.; freelancing and contracting remain material at 16.4%.

02

Use hybrid as the retention baseline

In-person work is rising to 20%, but hybrid remains the dominant arrangement at 42%.

03

Budget premiums for DevRel, SRE, and cloud infrastructure

Dev Advocates, SREs, and Cloud Infra. Engineers command high medians relative to many application roles.

04

Treat language ecosystems as compensation signals

Erlang, Clojure, and Elixir all exceed \$93K median; JavaScript and PHP sit below \$65K.

05

Engage developers directly in vendor strategy

62% influence tech purchases; free trials and peer input are the leading evaluation paths.

Use these benchmarks to calibrate role-level offers, refine hybrid-work policy, and target developer influencers throughout hiring and tooling decisions.